



Armenian University
Coalition for Biodiversity



Armenian Youth
Biodiversity
Network

Biodiversity Ambassador Program *Opening Ceremony & In-Person Training Program*

Date: September 12, 2026

Location: American University of Armenia Alex and Marie Manoogian Hall, 40 Marshal Baghramyan Ave., Yerevan, Armenia

Target Audience: Selected Biodiversity Ambassador Candidates (200-300 students)

Overall Duration: ~7 Hours (Including Breaks & Lunch)

Program Overview

This intensive foundational training serves as the official launch of the Biodiversity Ambassador Program. It welcomes the selected cohort, formalizes the Armenian University Coalition for Biodiversity (AUCB), and equips participants with the essential knowledge, soft skills, and team-building experiences needed to support COP17.

Event Schedule

Time	Duration	Session Description	Speaker / Facilitator
10:00 - 10:30	30 mins	Registration & Welcome <i>Arrival of students, distribution of ambassador training materials and name badges.</i>	Organizing Team
10:30 - 11:00	30 mins	Welcome & Keynote Speeches <i>Official welcome to the candidates and introduction to the vision behind the program and the importance of youth involvement.</i>	Alen G. Amirkhanian , <i>Director, American University of Armenia (AUA) Acopian Center for the Environment</i> Dr. Bruce Boghosian , <i>President, AUA</i> Dr. Hovhannes Hovhannisyan , <i>Rector, Yerevan State University</i> Aram Meymaryan , <i>Deputy Minister of Environment of the</i>

			<i>Republic of Armenia</i> Kristina Tataryan, Deputy Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sports of the Republic of Armenia (TBC) Mher Margaryan, Special Envoy for the 17th Conference of the Parties (COP17), Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Trade of the Republic of Armenia Françoise Jacob, UN Resident Coordinator in Armenia (TBC) Anna Shakhnazarian, GYBN Armenia Coordinator
11:00 - 11:20	20 mins	Official Signing Ceremony <i>Formal signing of the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to officially establish the Armenian University Coalition for Biodiversity (AUCB).</i>	Dr. Mikayel Hovhannisyan, Deputy Rector of YSU and AUCB Coalition Member Representatives
11:20 - 11:30	10 mins	Break	-
11:30 - 11:40	10 mins	Networking Icebreaker: Human Bingo <i>A high-energy, interactive game designed to break the ice, encourage multicultural mixing, and build early connections among the 300+ attendees.</i>	Narek Ohanyan, Researcher, AUA Acopian Center for the Environment
11:40 - 11:50	10 mins	Representing GYBN Global and GYBN Armenia	Elen Markosyan, GYBN Armenia

		<i>An overview of GYBN Global, GYBN Armenia, membership, and more.</i>	
11:50 - 12:00	10 mins	Setting the Stage: Shared Goals & Ambassador Manifesto <i>An overview of the program's structure, defining the ultimate goals for COP17, and drafting/presenting a shared "Ambassador Manifesto" and ground rules.</i>	Narek Ohanyan , <i>Researcher, AUA Acopian Center for the Environment</i>
12:00 - 12:30	30 mins	Coffee Break	-
12:30 - 13:15	45 mins	All About COP17: Armenia's Role & Global Impact <i>A deep dive into the Convention on Biological Diversity, what COP17 means for Armenia, and the concrete impact ambassadors will have on the proceedings.</i>	Alen G. Amirkhanian , AUA Acopian Center for the Environment
13:15 - 13:30	15 mins	Armenian Biodiversity Challenge: Interactive Quiz <i>A fun, competitive trivia session testing participants' knowledge of local flora and fauna. Concludes with distinguishing and awarding the winner.</i>	Elen Markosyan , GYBN Armenia
13:30 - 14:20	50 mins	Lunch	-
14:20 - 14:50	30 mins	International Agreements and Environment: What is special about CBD? <i>A targeted session focusing on international environmental law, international environmental agreements and more.</i>	Davit Khachatryan , AUA Acopian Center for the Environment

14:50 - 15:20	30 mins	Into Action: Ambassador Role-Play Simulation & Reflection- Part I <i>Interactive scenario-based exercises where participants practice guiding visitors, handling delegate support, and responding to unexpected logistical or multicultural challenges.</i>	Alen G. Amirkhanian, Narek Ohanyan, <i>AUA Acopian Center for the Environment</i> Anna Shakhnazarian, Elen Markosyan, GYBN Armenia
15:20 - 15:50	30 mins	Coffee Break	-
15:50 - 16:50	60 mins	Into Action: Ambassador Role-Play Simulation & Reflection - Part II <i>Interactive scenario-based exercises where participants practice guiding visitors, handling delegate support, and responding to unexpected logistical or multicultural challenges.</i>	Alen G. Amirkhanian, Narek Ohanyan, <i>AUA Acopian Center for the Environment</i> Anna Shakhnazarian, Elen Markosyan, GYBN Armenia
16:50 - 17:00	10 mins	Open Forum: Q&A and Closing Remarks <i>An open mic session for students to ask questions about the project and reflect on the day's learnings.</i>	Alen G. Amirkhanian, Narek Ohanyan, <i>AUA Acopian Center for the Environment</i>